



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cornerstone Classical School – Round Rock
School Website: <https://www.cscctx.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Cornerstone Classical School Round Rock, TX (77429) demonstrates a robust classical-Christian orientation across most of the six classical-school criteria. Public materials consistently frame a Christ-centered, virtue- and wisdom-forming mission, with explicit theology and biblical foundations, a Trivium-aligned curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and pedagogy that blends memory work and liturgical/chanting elements in lower grades with Socratic, seminar-style, and rhetorically oriented upper-level work. Leadership development, family partnership, and open engagement with parents are prominent. The strongest alignments are Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The Curriculum category is present and substantial but displays partial alignment due to the absence (in public-facing materials) of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language beyond classic-canon resource lists; this keeps Curriculum at a "Somewhat Classical" level rather than fully Classical. The aggregate assessment places Cornerstone as CLASSICAL overall, with a clearly articulated classical framework, explicit theological grounding, and structured classical pedagogy, while leaving room to more explicitly foreground Great Books/Great Conversation in curriculum messaging.

Observations at a glance: - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: Clear Christ-centered theology, biblical grounding, and liturgical/community orientation evidenced by mission, theology statements, and faith-language in public materials. CLASSICAL. - Purpose & Goal: Formation in virtue and wisdom, pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than mere job prep; deep formation language present. CLASSICAL. - Curriculum: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric emphasized; history integrated; curriculum list includes classic/Christian scholarly resources; however explicit Great Books/Great Conversation messaging is less explicit in public text. Somewhat Classical. - Pedagogy: Lower grades emphasize memory work, chanting, and wonder; upper grades engage Socratic discussion and rhetoric training; clearly multi-Modal classical pedagogy. CLASSICAL. - Faculty: Faculty described as collaborators with families, living the curriculum, and modeling virtue; intentional portrayal of faculty as core to the school's culture. CLASSICAL. - Parents & Community: Strong emphasis on partnership with families, co-teaching, family discipleship, and open campus/visits; explicit parent formation and community engagement. CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle: For a fully CLASSICAL rating, it would help to more explicitly foreground Great Books and Great Conversation language in Curriculum messaging (e.g., explicit Great Books lists, Great Conversation framing, and primary-source reading emphasis) and to more directly articulate liturgical/cultic practices as part of daily school life (if not already evident in local culture). See section: What would move the needle.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission statements emphasize collaborating with families to provide a classical Christian education in a Christ-centered community, developing leaders and virtue for the glory of God. - Public materials reference a biblical worldview and doctrinal grounding (Statement of Faith), including beliefs about Scripture as God's Word and the triune God. - The school's motto and citations indicate Christ as the cornerstone of the community and formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Christ-centered, Bible/Word of God, biblical worldview, gospel/faith, glory of God, theology, liturgical/community orientation (e.g., Family Discipleship, worship-oriented language). - Negative keywords observed: None evident in public materials (no evidence of secularism, relativism, or values-clarification signals in these texts).

Why this rating - The materials present a clear transcendental moral framework anchored in Christian theology and a liturgical/community sense, with explicit references to biblical truth and virtue formation. The public materials align strongly with the Positive Keywords in the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations axis.

Citations - Mission: Christ-centered, biblical formation, virtue, glory of God. - Statement of Faith (biblical-theological grounding). - Christ as cornerstone language.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission explicitly states formation in virtue and wisdom, not solely job preparation, with aim to form leaders and disciples for a lifetime of wisdom and virtue. - Public text expresses a telos aligned with truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, with human flourishing through virtue and character. - The broader messaging emphasizes forming humans of virtue and Christian character (e.g., history of formation language and family partnership).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, truth/goodness/beauty, virtue formation, living with intention, character formation. - Negative keywords observed: None relevant; no emphasis on purely vocational or job-readiness language.

Why this rating - The school's stated aims center on forming virtuous, wise human beings within a Christian framework, aligning strongly with Classical aims for formation over information.

Citations - Mission emphasizing formation of virtue and wisdom. - Truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable; formation over mere information.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Curriculum page and related materials highlight a Trivium-oriented structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across Pre-K to 12 and show alignment with a language-rich, classical approach. Public materials discuss a curriculum designed for Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric levels. - The curriculum lists include classical and historically significant resources (All About Reading/Spelling, Classical Academic Press, IEW, Lost Tools of Writing, Memoria Press, Story of the World, Mystery of History, Well-Trained Mind), indicating a classical-leaning toolkit. - History and historical-literary framing appears across the curriculum and campus messaging (e.g., history-focused history resources, classical-literary approach). - Great Books/Great Conversation language appears less explicitly in public-facing text; the materials emphasize classical resources rather than the explicit Great Books/GW conversations messaging. Some history/history-literature integration exists through resources, but not a central Great Books framing in the public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium, liberal arts, Great Books (not explicit in all pages but present in classical-resource lists), primary sources/history, language-rich curriculum. - Negative keywords observed: explicit phrases emphasizing "social studies" replacement or heavy emphasis on project-based learning in lieu of traditional canonical texts are not evident in public texts; however, absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing is a liminal signal. - Overall, the site demonstrates strong Trivium emphasis and classical-resource use but lacks explicit promotion of Great Books/Great Conversation language in public-facing curriculum messaging.

Why this rating - The presence of grammar, logic, and rhetoric, plus historical/cultural-literature resources, supports a Classical orientation. The absence (in public text) of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing reduces it from fully Classical to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations - Curriculum emphasis on grammar, logic, rhetoric (Trivium). - Classical-resource lists (IEW, Lost Tools of Writing, Memoria Press, Story of the World, Mystery of History, Well-Trained Mind). - History integration and language-rich approach (public materials).

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memory work, and recitation as a core experience (conscious cultivation of memory and delight). This is explicitly noted in curriculum/grammar-stage material. - Upper-school pedagogy emphasizes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training; students engage in seminars and rhetorical work, with opportunities for public speaking. - The pedagogy sections describe a continuum from contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) to rigorous Socratic engagement and rhetoric-based expression, aligning with classical pedagogy patterns. - There is clear articulation of a sequence from grammar (memory, chant, recitation) to logic (reasoned argument) to rhetoric (speeches, declamation).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: scholé (restful/ contemplative learning), memory work, recitation, chanting, liturgical integration, Socratic discussions, seminars, debates, rhetoric training, public speaking. - Negative keywords observed: experiential learning or project-based-only approaches are not evidenced as the dominant pedagogy; the public-facing materials emphasize structured, classical pedagogy rather than purely constructivist approaches. - The presence of both memory-based lower-school practices and Socratic/rhetoric-focused upper-school practices maps strongly to Classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a canonical progression matching classical pedagogy: memory-based, contemplative lower-school practice, followed by Socratic seminars and rhetoric-based upper-school activities. This aligns with Classic Program pedagogy.

Citations - Lower-school chant/memory/recitation. - Upper-school Socratic discussions, seminars, rhetoric training. - Contemplative/restful learning plus “scholé” framing in the materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Work With Us page emphasizes that Cornerstone faculty collaborate with families to provide a classical Christian education in a Christ-centered community, with faculty guiding students toward wisdom and virtue. This signals model-teacher/moral exemplar role and a living curriculum approach. - Faculty are presented as the core of the school’s culture (living curriculum, faculty of friends) via public materials and staff pages that describe mentoring, leadership development, and collaboration with families. The leadership development section shows structured mentorship and leadership roles for students, highlighting faculty as mentors. - Public content includes the presence of named faculty leadership (Georgetown Headmaster, Round Rock Campus points) and staff involved in leadership-development programs.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, faculty as mentors, model teachers, faculty of friends, living exemplars, character formation, mentorship, partnership with families. - Negative keywords observed: no evidence of “facilitator-on-the-side” or excessive non-classical jargon; the materials present a traditional, teacher-centered/classical faculty frame. - The presence of mission-driven teacher leadership and collaborative faculty-student relationships aligns with classical-faculty indicators.

Why this rating - The materials portray faculty as central actors in formation and as living exemplars, with explicit language about virtue, wisdom, and leadership, consistent with classical expectations for faculty.

Citations - Faculty as collaborators and living curriculum (Work With Us). - Leadership development showing faculty mentorship and student leadership roles. - Named staff and leadership figures (Georgetown Round

Rock) present in campus pages.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on collaborating with families to provide classical education, indicating parents as co-teachers and partners in formation. This is reinforced by family-discipleship content and campus-community language (Family Discipleship, Our Campuses, Community Life). - The site describes open engagement with parents (admissions, campus days, information meetings, family involvement), and emphasizes parent formation and involvement (family discipleship, co-teaching language). - Public content emphasizes “partners with families” and opportunities for parent involvement, campus visits, and gatherings.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teaching, parent formation, family discipleship, open campus/visit access, community-life involvement, collaborative school culture. - Negative keywords observed: none that signal consumerism or minimal parent involvement; the language emphasizes partnership and formation rather than mere consumption.

Why this rating - The school’s messaging consistently treats parents as co-educators and partners, with clear calls for parental involvement, formation, and community engagement. This aligns fully with classical-community expectations for Parents & Community.

Citations - Mission describing collaboration with families and virtue-focused aims. - Family Discipleship and Our Campuses language. - Open-campus/visit and community-life references.

Aggregate assessment and overall classification

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Curriculum category (Element 3): To elevate from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL, explicitly foreground “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” in Curriculum messaging. Public materials could articulate a canonical Great Books program, primary-source reading lists, and a strong emphasis on engagement with seminal Western texts as part of the Great Conversation. Including explicit language about Great Books, canonical authors, and the Great Conversation would strengthen the category’s alignment with the classical rubric. Additionally, highlighting direct connections to the Great Books canon in the Circle of study (e.g., named canonical works that students read across grades) would move the needle definitively.
- Consider making liturgical/community practices more explicit in public-facing materials (e.g., a dedicated note on liturgy, chapel, or communal worship cadence in daily life) to strengthen Element 1’s liturgical dimension if that is part of school practice.

Citations - Curriculum alignment (grammar, logic, rhetoric; classical resources) cited above. - Call for Great Books/Great Conversation explicitly in public materials would move Element 3 toward CLASSICAL. See current absence in explicit Great Books framing.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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